

**THE PUNJAB WILDLIFE (PROTECTION, PRESERVATION,
CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT) ACT, 1974**
(II of 1974)

Prohibition to employ hawk, falcon or dog without special licence CONTENTS

1. Short title, extent and commencement.
2. Definitions.
3. Appointment of officers and officials.
4. [omitted].
5. Constitution of the Board.
6. Functioning of the Board.
7. Fund.
8. Returns and statements.
9. Restriction of hunting.
10. Prohibition to employ hawk, falcon or dog without special licence.
- 10-A. Cruelty to animal prohibited
- 10-B. Captivity of a wild animal
11. Animals found dead or killed or caught unlawfully.
12. Certificate of lawful possession.
13. Restriction on transfer of animals, trophies or meat.
14. Restriction on import and export of animals, trophies or meat.
15. Restriction on dealings in animals, trophies or meat.
16. * * * *.
- 16-A. Wildlife breeding farm.
17. * * * *.
18. * * * *.
- 18-A. Wildlife park, zoological or zoo and safari park.

19. * * * * *
20. Private safari parks, private wildlife parks, private wildlife breeding farms and circusgame reserve, wildlife park and safari park.
21. Penalties.
22. Abetment of an offence.
- 22-A. Whistle-blower disclosure
23. Killing or capturing in self-defence.
24. Onus of proof.
25. Power to search without warrant.
26. Power to seizure.
27. Procedure as to perishable property seized under section 26.
28. Duty to produce permit on demand made by any officer or person authorised in this behalf.
29. Duty of coupe purchaser, chowkidar, village watchman, etc.
30. Procedure when offender not known or cannot be found.
- 30-A. Establishment of Wildlife Protection Centers.
- 30-B. Powers and functions of incharge of Wildlife Protection Center
- 30-C. Maintenance of record at Wildlife Protection Center
- 30-D. Chief Wildlife Ranger
- 30-E. Powers and functions of an officer
- 30-F. Investigating Officer
- 30-G. Procedure to be followed after arrest
- 30-H. Cognizance and trial of offences
- 30-I. Submission of report
31. [omitted]
32. [omitted]
33. Power to prevent commission of offence.
34. [omitted]

- 35. [omitted]
- 36. [omitted].
- 37. Prosecution of offences under any other law.
- 38. Power to compound offence.
- 39. Government may invest officer with certain powers.
- 40. Officers, etc. to be public servants.
- 41. Protection of action taken under this Act.
- 42. Duty of police officer.
- 43. Delegation of powers.
- 44. Power to grant exemption.
- 44-A. Power of sale or exchange.
- 44-B Hunting of wild animals
- 45. Power to add to or exclude from Schedules.
- 46. Power to make rules.
- 47. Dissolution of the Board.
- 48. Repeal and validation.
- 49. Repeal of Punjab Ordinance No. XX of 1973.

SCHEDULES

TEXT

**¹THE PUNJAB WILDLIFE (PROTECTION, PRESERVATION,
CONSERVATION AND MANAGEMENT) ACT, 1974**

(II of 1974)

[1st February, 1974]

**An
Act**

*to provide for the protection, preservation, conservation and management of wildlife
in the Province of the Punjab.*

Preamble.— WHEREAS it is expedient to provide for the protection, preservation, conservation and management of wildlife in the Province of the Punjab, in the manner hereinafter appearing;

It is hereby enacted as follows:—

1. Short title, extent and commencement.— (1) This Act may be called the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) Act, 1974.

(2) It extends to the whole of the Province of the Punjab.

(3) It shall come into force at once and shall be deemed to have taken effect on and from the day the Punjab Ordinances Temporary Enactment Act, 1973 (Punjab Act No. VI of 1973), in so far as it enacted the provisions of the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) Ordinance, 1972 (Ordinance No. XXI of 1972), expired.

(4) Nothing hereinafter provided shall be deemed to authorise any person to hunt in the reserved or protected forests as constituted and declared under the provisions of the Forest Act, 1927 (Act XVI of 1927).

2. Definitions.— In this Act, unless the context otherwise requires, the following words and expressions shall have the meanings hereby respectively assigned to them, that is to say—

(a) “Board” means the Punjab ²[Protected Areas and] Wildlife Management Board constituted under section 5;

³[(ab) “captive animal” means a wild animal as reflected in First Schedule, Second Schedule and Fourth Schedule and is in captivity under a licence as provided in section 10-B;]

¹This Act was passed by the Punjab Assembly on 28th January, 1974; assented to by the Governor of the Punjab on 1st February, 1974; and, published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 1st February, 1974, pages 117-K to 117-GG.

²Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(a).

³Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(b).

- (b) “certificate”, “licence”, “special licence”, “permit” or “special permit” means respectively a certificate, a licence, a special licence, a permit or a special permit granted or issued under this Act;
- ⁴[(ba) “Chief Wildlife Ranger” means the Chief Wildlife Ranger as provided in section 30-D of this Act;]
- ⁵[(bb) “circus” means a collection of wild animal declared as such under section 20;]
- ⁶[(bc) “Code” means the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1898 (V of 1898);
- (bd) “Court” means a Special Court notified under section 30-I of this Act;
- (be) “cruelty to animal” means depriving an animal of food, water, shelter, or veterinary care or an act of torturing, maiming, displaying, poisoning, killing or arranging fighting between animals or birds save as otherwise provided under this Act;]
- (c) “dealer”, when used in relation to wild animals, trophies or meat, shall mean any person who, in the course of trade or business carried on by him whether on his own behalf or on behalf of any other person,—
 - (i) sells, purchases or barter any wild animal, its meat or trophy;
 - (ii) cuts, carves, polishes, preserves, cleans, mounts or otherwise prepares any such animal, trophy or meat, or manufactures any article therefrom;
- ⁷[(cc) “endemic” means wildlife species native to Pakistan;]
- ⁸[(ccc) “exotic” means wildlife species not native to Pakistan;]
- ⁹[(cccc) “First Information Report” means a written document formulated by an authorized Wildlife Ranger on receipt of a report or information oral or written from a Wildlife Ranger or any person about the commission of a cognizable offence punishable under this Act or Punjab Protected Areas Act, 2020 (XXIII of 2020);]
- ¹⁰[(d) “game animal” means a wild animal specified in the First or the Fourth Schedule;]
- (e) “game reserve” means any area declared as such under section 18;
- (f) “Government” means the Government of the Punjab;

⁴Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(c).

⁵Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.2.

⁶Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(d).

⁷Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.2.

⁸*Ibid.*

⁹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(e).

¹⁰Substituted *ibid.*

- (g) “hunt” means any act directed immediately to the killing or capturing of a wild animal and shall include taking the nest or egg of a wild animal;
- ¹¹[(ga) “Investigating Officer” means such Wildlife Ranger appointed by the Chief Wildlife Ranger to investigate the case registered with the Wildlife Protection Center under this Act;]
- (h) “meat” means the fat, blood, flesh or any eatable part of wild animal, whether fresh or preserved;
- (i) “national park” means an area declared as such under section 17;
- (j) “offence” means an offence punishable under this Act or any rule made thereunder;
- ¹²[(ja) “offender” means a person who has committed or against whom there is a reasonable belief or suspicion that he has committed a violation or offence under this Act or Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020);]
- ¹³¹⁴[(k) “officer” means the Chief Wildlife Warden, Director General Wildlife and Parks, Chief Wildlife Ranger, Additional Chief Wildlife Ranger, Deputy Chief Wildlife Ranger, Assistant Chief Wildlife Ranger, Head Wildlife Ranger, Senior Wildlife Ranger and Wildlife Ranger or any other officer appointed to perform any function under this Act;]]
- (l) “prescribed” means prescribed by rules;
- ¹⁵[* * * * *]
- ¹⁶[(mm) “private wildlife breeding farm” means an area declared as such under section 20;]
- ¹⁷[(mmm) “private wildlife park” means an area declared as such under section 20;]
- ¹⁸[(mmmm) “Prosecutor” means a Prosecutor as defined under the Punjab Criminal Prosecution Service (Constitution, Functions and Powers) Act 2006 (III of 2006);]
- (n) “Protected animal” means a wild animal specified in the Third Schedule;

¹¹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(f).

¹²Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(g).

¹³*Ibid.*

¹⁴Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(h).

¹⁵Omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(i).

¹⁶Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.2.

¹⁷*Ibid.*

¹⁸Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(j).

- (o) “rules” means rules made under this Act;
- (p) “Schedule” means Schedule appended to this Act;
- (q) “section” means a section of this Act;
- (r) “trophy” means a dead body or any horn, antler, tooth, tusk, bone, claw, hoof, skin, hair, feather, egg-shell or other durable part of game animal or protected animal whether or not included in a manufactured or processed articles;
- ¹⁹[(ra) “whistle-blower” means a person who, in public interest, discloses to Wildlife Ranger an actual or suspected violation or offence for cognizance under this Act or the Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020);]
- ²⁰[(s) “wild animal” means a wild bird or animal specified in the First, Second, Third and Fourth Schedules;]
- (t) “wildlife” includes organic resources, animals, birds, reptiles, vegetation, soil and water;
- ²¹[(tt) “wildlife breeding farm” means an area declared as such under section 16-A;]
- ²²[(ttt) “wildlife park” means an area declared as such under section 18-A;]
- ²³[(tttt) “safari park” means an area declared as such under section 18-A;]
- ²⁴[(ttttt) “Wildlife Protection Center” means a center notified under section 30-A of this Act;]
- (u) “wildlife sanctuary” means the area declared as such under section 16;
²⁵[* * *]
- ²⁶[(v) “unprotected animal” means a wild animal specified in the Fourth Schedule appended to this Act] ²⁷[; and]
- ²⁸[(w) “zoological garden or zoo” means an area declared as such under section 18-A.]

¹⁹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(k).

²⁰Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007) Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.2.

²¹Inserted *ibid*.

²²*ibid*.

²³*ibid*.

²⁴Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(l).

²⁵The word “and” omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.2.

²⁶Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 2(m).

²⁷Substituted *ibid*., for the full-stop.

²⁹**[3. Appointment of officers and officials.**– Government may determine the number and class of officers, officials and other staff to be appointed under this Act on such terms and conditions as may be prescribed.]

³⁰[* * * * *]

5. Constitution of the Board.– (1) Government shall establish a Board to be called the Punjab ³¹[Protected Areas and] Wildlife Management Board.

(2) The Board shall be a body corporate having perpetual succession and a common seal with power to acquire and hold property and shall by the said name sue and be sued.

(3) The Board shall consist of–

(a) a Chairman;

(b) a Vice-Chairman; and

(c) such number of members as may be appointed by Government.

³²[(4) The Minister for Forestry, Wildlife and Fisheries shall be the Chairman of the Board and he shall also be the Chief Wildlife Warden under this Act.

³³[(5) The Secretary to the Government, Forestry, Wildlife and Fisheries Department shall be the Vice-Chairman and ex-officio member of the Board.]

(6) A member, other than ex-officio member, shall, unless he sooner resigns or is removed by Government, hold office for such term as may be prescribed.

³⁴[(7) The Director General, Wildlife and Parks shall be the Secretary and ex-officio member of the Board.]]

(8) The meetings of the Board shall be held in accordance with such procedure as may be prescribed.

²⁸Inserted *ibid*.

²⁹Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 3.

³⁰Omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 4.

³¹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 5(i).

³²Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 5(ii).

³³Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Ordinance, 2002 (XVII of 2002); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 5.4.2002, pages 1257-1258,s.2, which will remain in force under the Provisional Constitution (Amendment) Order 1999 (9 of 1999), Article 4, notwithstanding the maximum limit of three months prescribed under Article 128 of the Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan.

³⁴Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Ordinance, 2002 (XVII of 2002) ; and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 5.4.2002, pages 1257-1258,s.2, which will remain in force under the Provisional Constitution (Amendment) Order 1999 (9 of 1999), Article 4, notwithstanding the maximum limit of three months prescribed under Article 128 of the Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan.

³⁵**[6. Functioning of the Board.]**— The Board shall act in an advisory capacity and its functions shall be—

- (a) to advise about the formulation of policy regarding conservation and development of wildlife and game management in the Province;
- (b) to supervise the progress of the development activities in the field of wildlife protection, preservation, conservation, and management and to scrutinize the annual progress report submitted in this behalf; and
- (c) to undertake such other functions as may be prescribed.]

7. Fund.— (1) There shall be a fund to be known as “Board Fund” vested in the Board. The Fund shall be raised and administered in such manner as may be prescribed.

(2) All moneys at the credit of the Board shall be kept in such custody as may be prescribed.

(3) The Board shall maintain complete and accurate books of accounts in such form as may be prescribed.

(4) The accounts of the Board shall be audited in such manner as may be prescribed.

(5) Copies of the audit report shall be sent to the Board.

(6) The Board shall take necessary steps for rectification of an audit objection.

8. Returns and statements.— Government may require the Board to furnish Government with any document, return, statement, estimate, information or report regarding any matter under the control of the Board and the Secretary of the Board shall comply with every such requisition.

9. Restriction of hunting.— No person shall:—

- ³⁶[(i) hunt any wild animal by means of ³⁷[PCP air guns, CO2 air guns or silenced air guns,] a set gun, drop spear, deadfall, gun trap, explosive, projectile, bomb, grenade, baited hook, net, snare or any other trap, an automatic or a service weapon or ammunition used by Armed Forces of Pakistan, Police Force or any other force, or by means of any drug or chemical substance, likely to anesthetize, paralyze, stupefy or render incapable any wild animal whether partly or totally through a projectile or otherwise;]
- (ii) hunt any protected animal;
- (iii) hunt any game animal except under a permit and in accordance with the provisions of this Act or the rules:

³⁵Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Ordinance, 1983 (V of 1983); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 9.3.1974, s.2.

³⁶Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.4.

³⁷Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2023 (X of 2023), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 17 February 2023, pp. 3885, s.2.

Provided that no person shall hunt any game animal other than bird or hare with a shot gun or with non-magnum rifle of 22 calibre or less;

- (iv) use or have in his possession any net, snare, *bhagwa*, poison or like injurious substance for the purpose of hunting a game animal;
- (v) use vehicle of any type to pursue any game animal or to drive or stampede game animal for any purpose whatsoever;
- (vi) shoot any game animal except wild boar and vermin from any conveyance or from within two hundred yards of the conveyance;
- (vii) hunt with the help of live decoys or call birds except quail;
- (viii) construct or use, for the purpose of hunting any wild animal, any pitfall, game pit, trench or similar excavation, any fence or enclosure, or use *bhagwa* or any other similar contrivance except duck blinds:

Provided that it shall not be an offence to use:—

- (a) a motor vehicle or aircraft to drive any wild animal away from an aerodrome or airstrip when such action is necessary to ensure the safety of aircraft using that aerodrome;
- (b) any one or more of the aforesaid prohibited methods if the officer authorised in this behalf grants a licence with permission to employ such method; or
- (c) to hunt any un-protected animal;
- (ix) hunt except ducks, wild boars and vermin after sunset and before sunrise; and
- (x) hunt by hiding within two hundred yards of a water hole or salt licks.

³⁸**[10. Prohibition to employ hawk, falcon or dog without special licence.**— No person shall employ a hawk for hawking or falcon for falconry or dog for coursing as game animal except under a licence issued for the purpose under this Act.]

³⁹**[10-A. Cruelty to animal prohibited.**— No person shall be allowed to act or manage or demonstrate or try to act or manage or demonstrate any activity in respect of cruelty to a wild animal.

10-B. Captivity of a wild animal.— No person shall keep a wild animal reflected in Schedules I, II and IV as captive animal except under a licence to be issued by the Director General, Wildlife and Parks in such manner, on payment of such fee and on such terms and conditions as may be prescribed.]

11. Animals found dead or killed or caught unlawfully.— Any ⁴⁰[wild] animal which is found dead or dying or which has been killed or caught otherwise than in

³⁸Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 6.

³⁹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 7.

⁴⁰Substituted for the words “protected animal or game”, by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.5.

accordance with the provisions of this Act and any meat or trophy thereof shall be the property of ⁴¹[Government].

12. Certificate of lawful possession.— (1) No person shall be in possession of any wild animal unless he be in possession of a certificate of lawful possession granted in respect thereof by the officer authorised in this behalf:

Provided that any person importing any wild animal, trophy or meat of a wild animal of a kind specified in the Second Schedule in accordance with the provisions of this Act or acquiring such animal, trophy or meat in accordance with the terms of a permit issued under this Act shall apply to the authorised officer for such certificate within thirty days from the date of importing or acquiring the animal, trophy or meat.

(2) The officer authorised in this behalf may mark or register the animal trophy or meat in respect of which a certificate of lawful possession is issued, in the prescribed manner, or he may seize, pending the taking of legal action under this Act, any such animal, trophy or meat which in his opinion has not been legally imported or acquired.

(3) No person shall counterfeit, change or in any way interfere with any mark or registration of animal, trophy or meat for which a certificate of lawful possession has been issued or alter or in any way change a certificate of lawful possession.

13. Restriction on transfer of animals, trophies or meat.— No person shall receive by gift, purchase or otherwise any animal of a kind specified in the Second Schedule unless he receives at the same time a valid certificate of lawful possession in respect thereof.

14. Restriction on import and export of animals, trophies or meat.— (1) No person shall import or attempt to import into the Punjab any wild animal of endemic or exotic species, or any trophy or meat of a kind specified in Second Schedule except under an import permit granted under this Act and if such import be from outside Pakistan except through a customs post of entry and subject to any law relating to control on imports for the time being in force.

(2) No person shall export or attempt to export out of the Punjab any ⁴²[wild] animal, trophy or meat specified in Second Schedule except under an export permit granted under this Act and if such export be to any country outside Pakistan except through a customs post of exit and subject to any law relating to control on export for the time being in force.

(3) Nothing in this section shall apply to any ⁴³[wild] animal, trophy or meat in transit through the Punjab if such animal, trophy or meat—

(i) is accompanied by necessary transit customs documents;

⁴¹*ibid.*, for the word “Board”.

⁴²Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007)); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.6.

⁴³Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007)); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.6.

- (ii) is entered through a customs post of entry or is scheduled to a customs post of exit; or
- (iii) in case of road transport, is either not un-loaded from the conveyance on which it is being carried or does not remain unloaded from such conveyance for more than ninety-six hours, or in case of rail or air transport, it does not leave the precincts of the railway station or airport at which it is landed or trans-shipped.

15. Restriction on dealings in animals, trophies or meat.— (1) No person shall as a profession, trade or business, buy, sell or otherwise deal in wild animals, trophies or meat thereof or process or manufacture goods or articles from such trophies or meat, unless he is in possession of a valid licence, hereinafter called a dealer's licence, to do so, issued by an officer authorised in this behalf.

(2) The officer authorised in this behalf may, on payment of such fees as may be prescribed, grant a dealer's licence to be valid for one year to any person which shall entitle the licensee to deal in any wild animal, trophy or meat thereof, or any class of wild animals, trophies or meat specified in such licence. Such licence shall be renewable in such manner as may be prescribed.

(3) For the purpose of assessment of fees, dealers may be divided into different classes and a different fees may be prescribed for each class.

(4) The holder of the dealer's licence shall maintain such register or record of his dealings in such manner as may be prescribed, and shall produce them for inspection at any reasonable time when called upon to do so.

⁴⁴[* * * * *]

⁴⁵**[16-A. Wildlife breeding farm.**— (1) The Government may, by notification in the official Gazette, declare any area, which is the property of the Government or over which the Government has the proprietary rights, to be a wildlife breeding farm.

(2) The following acts shall be prohibited in the wildlife breeding farm:—

- (a) hunting, shooting, trapping, killing or capturing of a wild animal;
- (b) firing or doing any other act which may disturb a wild animal or interfere with the breeding places;
- (c) felling, tapping, burning or in any manner damaging, destroying, taking, collecting, removing or taking away a plant or tree or leave, fruit or seed therefrom;
- (d) polluting water flowing in or through the wildlife park;
- (e) any act of feeding or teasing a wild animal;
- (f) damaging of any structure;
- (g) any act of teasing or harassing visitors or otherwise, creating any pandemonium; and

⁴⁴Repealed by the Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 10 September 2020, pp. 1057-1066, s. 34(1).

⁴⁵Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.7.

(h) any act in violation of any restrictions imposed by the Government:

Provided that the Government may, for such purposes as it may deem expedient, authorize the doing of the aforementioned prohibited acts except at paras (d), (e), (g), and (h).]

⁴⁶[* * * * *

⁴⁷⁴⁸[* * * * *

⁴⁹[**18-A. Wildlife park, zoological garden or zoo and safari park.**– (1) The Government may, by notification in the official gazette, declare an area which is the property of the Government or over which the Government has proprietary rights, to be a wildlife park to maintain wild animal in captivity and in a state as close to nature as possible, for the purpose of breeding, re-introduction, recreation and public education.

(2) The Government may, by notification in the official gazette, declare an area which is the property of the Government or over which the Government has proprietary rights, to be a zoological garden or zoo to maintain, breed locally extinct, endangered or threatened species of wild animal for re-introduction, recreation and public education.

(3) The Government may, by notification in the official gazette, declare an enclosed area which is the property of the Government or over which the Government has proprietary rights, to be a safari park in which wild animal shall be kept in the open space for viewing by public from a vehicle driven through.

(4) Wildlife park, safari park or zoological garden or zoo shall be accessible to public for recreation, education and research purposes, subject to such restrictions as the Government may impose.

(5) Provision for access roads to and construction of cafeteria, motel, laboratory, research centre and any other building in the wildlife park, safari park or zoological garden or zoo alongwith amenities for public may be made for the facilitation of achievement of, and the forest vegetation therein shall be so managed and forest produce so obtained as not to impair the objectives of the establishment of such parks or zoological garden or zoo.

(6) The following acts shall be prohibited in the wildlife park, safari park or zoological garden or zoo:–

- (a) hunting, shooting, trapping, killing or capturing of a wild animal;
- (b) firing or doing any other act which may disturb a wild animal or interfere with the breeding place of a wild animal;

⁴⁶Repealed by the Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 10 September 2020, pp. 1057-1066, s. 34(1).

⁴⁷Repealed by the Punjab Protected Areas Act *ibid*.

⁴⁸Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.8.

⁴⁹Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.9.

- (c) felling, tapping, burning or in any manner damaging, destroying, taking, collecting, removing or taking away any plant or tree or leave, fruit or seed therefrom;
- (d) polluting water flowing in or through the wildlife park, zoological garden or zoo or safari park;
- (e) any act of feeding or teasing a wild animal;
- (f) damaging of any structure;
- (g) any act of teasing or harassing visitor or otherwise, creating any pandemonium; and
- (h) any act in violation of any restriction imposed by the Government:

Provided that the Government may for such purposes as it may deem expedient authorize the doing of any of the aforementioned prohibited act except at para (d), (e), (g) and (h).]

⁵⁰[* * * * *]

⁵¹[20. ⁵²[Private safari parks, private wildlife parks, private wildlife breeding farms and circus].– (1) Where the Government is satisfied that–

⁵³[* * * * *]

- (b) an area of land has been dedicated by its owner or owners, for the purposes similar to a safari park, it may, on the application of the owner or the owners, as the case may be, by notification in the official Gazette, declare such area to be a private safari park;
- (c) a collection of wild animal has been kept over an area of land dedicated by its owner or owners, for the purpose of breeding, sale, exchange, recreation, education and research, it may, on the application of the owner or the owners, as the case may be, by notification in the official gazette, declare such area to be a private wildlife park;
- (d) a collection of wild animal has been kept over an area of land dedicated by its owner or owners, for the purpose of breeding, sale and exchange, it may, on the application of the owner or the owners, as the case may be, by notification in the official gazette, declare such area to be a private wildlife breeding farm; and
- (e) a collection of wild animal has been dedicated by its owner or owners, for the purpose of exhibition, display and performance at public places,

⁵⁰Repealed by the Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 10 September 2020, pp. 1057-1066, s. 34(1).

⁵¹Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.10.

⁵²Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 8(a).

⁵³Omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 8(b).

it may, on the application of the owner or the owners, as the case may be, by notification in the official gazette, declare such collection to be a circus.

⁵⁴[* * * * *]

(3) Hunting and shooting of wild animal shall not be allowed in a private wildlife park, private safari park, circus and private wildlife breeding farm.]

⁵⁵**[21. Penalties.—** ⁵⁶[(1)] Whoever contravenes or attempts to contravene:—

- ⁵⁷[(i) any provision of sections 9, 11, 12, 13, 20 and 28, except clauses (ii) and (x) of section 9, shall be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend to five years but not less than two years, or with fine up to one million rupees but not less than fifty thousand rupees, or with both, along with confiscation of weapon, article, vehicle, equipment, machinery or any other thing used in commission of offence under this Act;
- (ii) any provision of clauses (ii) and (x) of section 9, sections 10, 14 and 15, except clauses (d), (e), (f), (g) and (h) of sub-section (2) of section 16-A and clauses (d), (e), (f), (g) and (h) of sub-section (6) of section 18-A, shall be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend to seven years but not less than five years or with fine up to five million rupees but not less than one hundred thousand rupees or with both, along with confiscation of weapon, article, vehicle, equipment, machinery or any other article used in commission of offence under this Act; and]
- (iii) any provision of this Act or any rule for the contravention of which no specific penalty is provided shall be punished with imprisonment for a term which may extend to ten months or with fine which may extend to ten thousand rupees or with both.]

⁵⁸[(2) An offence punishable under clauses (i) and (ii) shall be deemed to be cognizable and non-bailable for the purposes of the Code and shall be triable as provided under section 30-I.]

22. Abetment of an offence.— An abetment of any offence under this Act or the rules made thereunder shall be punishable ⁵⁹[with such punishment as provided for the offence abetted].

⁵⁴Omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 8(c).

⁵⁵Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007) ; and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.11.

⁵⁶Numbered as "(1)" by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 9(a).

⁵⁷Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 9(b).

⁵⁸Added by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 9(c).

⁵⁹Substituted for the words "as the offence" by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 10.

⁶⁰[**22-A. Whistle-blower disclosure.**- (1) Any person making a whistle-blower disclosure shall make a personal declaration that the information disclosed and allegations contained therein declaration are true to the best of his knowledge and belief, and are not disclosed for any personal reason.

(2) Every whistle-blower disclosure shall be made in writing or electronic form in such manner and accompanied by such documents or other material as may be prescribed.

(3) Upon receipt of whistle-blower disclosure, the Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or any other authorized officer shall make an assessment of the information contained in the disclosure and verify the same under intimation to the next higher authority in such manner as may be prescribed.

(4) Upon assessment and verification under sub-section (3), if the Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or authorized officer is of the view that the whistle-blower disclosure warrants further probe, inquiry or investigation, he shall complete such probe immediately but not later than twenty-four hours and take necessary action, if so required.

22-B. Reward and punishment.- (1) If any violation or offence is successfully detected by the Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or authorized officer on whistle-blower disclosure and offender is punished in consequence of such disclosure, such whistle-blower may be paid a reward as may be prescribed in addition to a certificate of appreciation by the Chief Wildlife Ranger:

Provided that in case of disclosures by more than one whistle-blowers for the same violation or offence, reward shall be equitably distributed amongst such whistle-blowers based on their respective contribution, as determined and deemed fit by the Chief Wildlife Ranger.

(2) In case a whistle-blower discloses such information which he knows or believes to be false, frivolous or vexatious and on such disclosure Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or authorized officer takes action under this Act, such whistle-blower shall, subject to being provided an opportunity of being heard, be liable to be punished with fine which may extend up to one hundred thousand rupees.

22-C. Protection of whistle-blower.- (1) The identity of a whistle-blower, other than provided in sub-section (2) of section 22-C, shall not be disclosed even after conclusion of proceedings, except with written consent of such whistle-blower, and in case, unauthorized disclosure of identity of such whistle-blower is made by an officer or official, it shall amount to misconduct under the Punjab Employees Efficiency, Discipline and Accountability Act 2006.

(2) The Chief Wildlife Ranger may, in consultation with whistle-blower, take necessary measure for his protection for such duration and in such manner as may be prescribed.

22-D. Incentive and compensation.- (1) The Chief Wildlife Ranger may grant

⁶⁰Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 11.

incentive or reward to Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or any other officer or official, who has made exceptional effort towards accomplishing the objective of this Act, in such manner as may be prescribed.

(2) Where Investigating Officer or Wildlife Ranger or any other officer or official suffers any bodily injury by any reason during performing his official duty for the purposes of this Act, Chief Wildlife Ranger may grant him such compensation as may be prescribed.]

23. Killing or capturing in self-defence.— (1) Notwithstanding any other provision of this Act, it shall not be an offence, if—

- (a) any person kills any wild animal by any means in the immediate defence of his own life or that of any other person;
- (b) the owner of livestock or his employee kills any wild animal that is doing damage to the livestock by any means within a reasonable distance or where that livestock is grazing or where it is enclosed for the night:

Provided that clause (b) shall not apply to any unlawful cultivation in a national park, wildlife sanctuary and a reserved or protected forest or any livestock unlawfully grazing or herded therein.

(2) The killing under sub-section (1) of wild animals specified in the First and Third Schedules shall be reported to the nearest office established for the purposes of this Act.

(3) The meat or trophy of any wild animal killed in self-defence shall be the property of Government and shall be disposed of as directed by the officer authorised in this behalf.

24. Onus of proof.— When in any proceedings taken under this Act or in consequence of anything done under this Act, a question arises as to whether any wild animal, trophy or meat is the property of ⁶¹[Government], such wild animal, trophy or meat shall be presumed to be the property of ⁶²[Government] until the contrary is proved.

25. Power to search without warrant.— Any officer authorised by Government in this behalf, may search any person, premises, vessel, vehicle, animal, packages, receptacle or covering so as to satisfy himself whether or not an offence under this Act has been committed:

Provided that no premises shall be searched under this section except under the authority of a warrant issued by the Magistrate having jurisdiction in the area.

26. Power to seizure.— Any officer authorised by Government in this behalf, may seize any wild animal, dead or alive, together with any firearm, net, trap, snare, bow,

⁶¹Substituted for the word "Board" by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.12.

⁶²*Ibid.*

arrow or any vehicle or vessel or anything whatsoever used or suspected to have been used in the commission of an offence under this Act.

27. Procedure as to perishable property seized under section 26.— Notwithstanding any other provision of this Act, the officer authorised in this behalf may sell any property seized under section 26 which is subject to speedy and natural decay and may, subject to the determination of the rights thereto, deal with the proceeds in such manner as may be prescribed.

28. Duty to produce permit on demand made by any officer or person authorised in this behalf.— Every person in possession of any wild animal specified in the First and Third Schedule shall produce his certificate of lawful possession on demand made by any officer authorised by Government in this behalf.

29. Duty of coupe purchaser, chowkidar, village watchman, etc.— Every coupe purchaser of forest produce, lambardar, canal patwari, Public Works Department, daroga, chowkidar, dafadar, village watchman, abdar, zilladar, revenue patwari, qanungo and tehsildar shall be bound, in the absence of reasonable excuse to give to any officer authorised in this behalf by Government, information in respect of any snaring, trapping, netting, unauthorised killing, or any other offence under this Act committed within the limits of his jurisdiction, as soon as the commission of such offence comes to his knowledge.

30. Procedure when offender not known or cannot be found.— When the offender is not known or cannot be found any officer authorised in this behalf may, if he finds that an offence has been committed, confiscate the property used in the commission of the offence.

⁶³**[30-A. Establishment of Wildlife Protection Centers.**— (1) The Government shall, by notification in the official Gazette, establish or declare one or more places or premises, generally or specially, as Wildlife Protection Center for the purposes of this Act to exercise such powers and perform such functions in such area as may be provided in the notification.

(2) Each Wildlife Protection Center shall consist of:

- (a) Head Wildlife Ranger;
- (b) Senior Wildlife Ranger;
- (c) Wildlife Ranger; and
- (d) any other official.

(3) The supervision of Wildlife Protection Center shall vest with an officer not below the rank of Assistant Chief Wildlife Ranger and Head Wildlife Ranger shall be incharge of Wildlife Protection Center and, in his absence, Senior Wildlife Ranger shall be the incharge.

(4) The Chief Wildlife Ranger or his authorized officer may assign any

⁶³Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 12.

officer to perform such duties in the Wildlife Protection Center for such a period and on such terms and conditions as may be provided in the order.

(5) The Wildlife Ranger shall be authorized to wear such uniform, carry such ammunition, keep such identification card or tag such badge and in such manner as may be prescribed.

(6) Each Wildlife Protection Center shall be provided such marked vehicles and motorbikes as may be deemed necessary.

(7) The supervision and administration of Wildlife Protection Center shall be made in such manner as may be prescribed.

30-B. Powers and functions of incharge of Wildlife Protection Center.— (1) An incharge of Wildlife Protection Center shall perform such functions and exercise such powers in such manner as may be prescribed.

(2) In addition to the powers and functions as may be prescribed under sub-section (1), incharge of Wildlife Protection Center, within its territorial jurisdiction, shall also:

- (a) enforce and execute decisions of Government;
- (b) enforce provisions of this Act and the Punjab Protected Areas Act 2020 (XXIII of 2020);
- (c) conduct inspections and inquiries;
- (d) register FIRs and conduct investigations;
- (e) arrest and submit reports;
- (f) issue orders under directions of the Board or Chief Wildlife Ranger; and
- (g) exercise such other powers and perform such other functions as may be delegated to him by the Chief Wildlife Ranger.

30-C. Maintenance of record at Wildlife Protection Center.— The incharge of Wildlife Protection Center shall be responsible to maintain record in such manner as may be prescribed.

30-D. Chief Wildlife Ranger.— (1) The Director General, Wildlife and Parks shall act as Chief Wildlife Ranger under this Act and shall:

- (a) be responsible for implementation of provisions of this Act and rules made thereunder;
- (b) also have powers of Wildlife Ranger for the purposes of this Act; and
- (c) exercise such other powers and perform such other functions as may be prescribed.

(2) The Chief Wildlife Ranger or in-charge of Wildlife Protection Center may direct to establish such number of wildlife check posts at such place as may

be deemed appropriate to prevent an offence and to protect wildlife under this Act.

30-E. Powers and functions of an officer.- (1) Subject to provisions of this Act, an officer, within his assigned jurisdiction, may, in a cognizable offence, arrest any person against whom a reasonable suspicion exists or credible information has been received of his having been involved in an offence, and, for this purpose, shall exercise all powers of a police-officer provided in the Code.

(2) An officer not below the rank of Assistant Chief Wildlife Ranger may seal any private wildlife reserve, private wildlife park and private safari park, if he has reason to believe that such private wildlife reserve, private wildlife park and private safari park is being established or used in contravention of provisions of this Act, or rules made thereunder.

(3) An officer may seize any wildlife animal, dead, or alive, trophy and its meat together with any firearm, net, trap, snare, bow, arrow or vehicle or vessel or anything whatsoever used or suspected to have been used in commission of offence under this Act.

(4) An officer not below the rank of Senior Wildlife Ranger may search and seize any shop or building or house or place where wild animal, parts of dead wildlife animal, trophy and its meat is kept, stored, hanged or displayed without authority or permission of Director General, Wildlife and Parks and may arrest owner of such shop, building or house, as the case may be.

(5) An officer not below the rank of Senior Wildlife Ranger may arrest any person who made any picture or photo or movie or clip or TikTok or any motion picture of hunting of any wild animal prohibited for hunting or game animal with any electronic or digital device or uploaded such picture, photo, movie, clip or TikTok on internet or any other social or electronic media platform and shall impound such electronic or digital device.

(6) An officer may perform such other functions as may be assigned by the Chief Wildlife Ranger.

30-F. Investigating Officer.- (1) The Chief Wildlife Ranger shall, by notification, appoint as many Investigating Officers for each Wildlife Protection Center as it may deem appropriate.

(2) The Investigating Officer shall have powers:

- (a) to enter, inspect, search and seal any public property, building, place or any premises where he has reason to believe that an offence under this Act has occurred or is apprehension of so happening;
- (b) to enter, inspect, search and seal any private property, building or place, subject to warrant or order of the Magistrate in whose jurisdiction such premises situate, where he has reason to believe that an offence under this Act has occurred or is apprehension of so happening;

- (c) to stop, inspect, search and seize any vehicle for the purposes of this Act;
- (d) issue notice or summon to offender under this Act;
- (e) seize any item, goods, article or property used in or relevant to prove the commission of offence, provided that every such item shall be listed in the register of seized items in the prescribed manner;
- (f) to use reasonable force, in case of retaliation or obstruction during discharge of his functions under this Act;
- (g) to collect evidence through electronic means to inquire or investigate, such as CCTV camera recording, video recording, audio recording, photographs, electronic data, caller data records, mobile device tracking, and digital forensics;
- (h) to get FIRs registered at Wildlife Protection Center;
- (i) save as in this Act, Investigating Officer shall also have all such powers as provided in the Code for the purposes of investigation; and
- (j) such other powers as may be prescribed.

30-G. Procedure to be followed after arrest.- (1) The arrest of a person shall be brought into the knowledge of incharge of Wildlife Protection Center and such arrested person shall, without unnecessary delay but not later than twenty-four hours from his arrest, be produced before the Court or in absence of Court before the area Magistrate for remand.

(2) The incharge of Protection Wildlife Center shall also submit a report about the registration of case to Chief Wildlife Ranger in such manner as may be prescribed.

30-H. Cognizance and trial of offences.- (1) A Special Court, duly notified by the Government, and in its absence Magistrate under section 30 of the Code shall take cognizance and try offence in the manner as provided in the Code and award punishment under this Act.

(2) An officer under this Act shall be a competent witness for the purposes of this Act before the Court.

30-I. Submission of report.- Report of the case shall be submitted in the Court through concerned District Public Prosecutor who shall defend the case in the Court.]

⁶⁴[* * * * *]

⁶⁵[* * * * *]

⁶⁴Omitted Section 31 by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 15.

⁶⁵Omitted Section 32 by the Act *ibid*.

33. Power to prevent commission of offence.— Every officer or any other person authorised by Government in this behalf shall be competent to prevent by all lawful means the commission of any offence under this Act.

⁶⁶[* * * * *]

⁶⁷[* * * * *]

⁶⁸⁶⁹[[* * * * *]]

37. Prosecution of offences under any other law.— Nothing contained in this Act shall be deemed to prevent any person from being prosecuted under any other law for any act of commission which constitutes an offence under this Act or from being liable under any other law to any higher punishment or penalty than that provided by this Act.

38. Power to compound offence.— (1) Government may, by notification in the official Gazette, empower an officer—

- (a) to accept from any person against whom reasonable suspicion exists that he has committed any offence under this Act, a sum of money by way of compensation for such offence;
- (b) when any property has been seized as liable to confiscation, to release the same on payment of the value thereof, as ⁷⁰[may be prescribed].

(2) On the payment of compensation, such sum of money, or such value of property under sub-section (1) or both, as the case may be, the suspected person if in custody, shall be discharged and the property, if any, seized shall be released and no further proceedings shall be taken against such person or property.

⁷¹⁷²[(3) The sum of money accepted as compensation under clause (a) of sub-section (1) shall be up to fifty thousand rupees at first charge to commit an offence under this Act and on repetition of offence, the amount of compensation shall be not less than the double of the amount of compensation accepted at first time.]]

(4) No officer shall have power to compound a ⁷³[third] and subsequent offence under this Act.

⁶⁶Omitted Section 34 by the Act *ibid*.

⁶⁷Omitted Section 35 by the Act *ibid*.

⁶⁸Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007) ; and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007,pages 1447-1451, s.13.

⁶⁹Omitted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 15.

⁷⁰Substituted for the words “estimated by such officer” by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007,pages 1447-1451, s.14.

⁷¹Substituted *ibid*.

⁷²Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 13.

⁷³Substituted for the word “second” by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007,pages 1447-1451, s.14.

39. Government may invest officer with certain powers.— Government may invest any officer or any other person authorised in this behalf with all or any of the following powers, that is to say—

- (a) the powers of a civil court to compel the attendance of witnesses and the production of documents and material objects;
- (b) the power to hold an inquiry into offences under this Act and in the course of such inquiry to receive and record evidence; and
- (c) the power to prosecute a case before a Magistrate.

40. Officers etc. to be public servants.— The officers or persons authorised under any provisions of this Act to do a certain thing or act in certain manner shall be deemed to be public servants within the meaning of the Pakistan Penal Code (Act XLV of 1860).

41. Protection of action taken under this Act.— No suit, prosecution or other legal proceedings shall lie against any officer for anything in good faith done or intended to be done in pursuance of any provision of this Act or the rules made thereunder.

42. Duty of police officer.— Every police officer shall, upon request made by any officer or person authorised under this Act, assist him in the due discharge of his duties under this Act.

43. Delegation of powers.— Government may, by notification in the official Gazette, delegate all or any of the powers conferred upon it under the provisions of this Act to any officer subordinate to it.

44. Power to grant exemption.— Notwithstanding anything contained in this Act, Government may, in the interest of any scientific or public purpose, allow, by notification in the official Gazette, hunting and capturing of such wild animals in any specified place by any specific means.

⁷⁴**[44-A. Power of sale or exchange.**— Notwithstanding anything contained in this Act, the Government may, for scientific management, allow sale or exchange of wild animal, from any wildlife breeding farm, wildlife park, safari park, zoological garden or zoo.]

⁷⁵**[44-B. Hunting of wild animals.**— Notwithstanding anything contained in any other law for the time being in force, Chief Wildlife Ranger or any officer authorized by him may, if he is satisfied that any wild animal has become dangerous to human being or other species or is so disabled or diseased as to be beyond recovery, by order, in writing and stating the reasons therefor, cull such animal or cause such animal to be culled in such manner as may be prescribed.]

⁷⁴Substituted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2007 (XII of 2007); and published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated 30.10.2007, pages 1447-1451, s.15.

⁷⁵Inserted by the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) (Amendment) Act 2025 (II of 2025), published in the Punjab Gazette (Extraordinary), dated: 27 January 2025, pp. 2557-2564, s. 14.

45. Power to add to or exclude from Schedules.— Government may, by notification in the official Gazette, in respect, to any specified area—

- (i) add to or exclude from the Schedules any wild animals, subject to such conditions as it may impose in each case; and
- (ii) alter the period during which any wild animal specified in the First Schedule may be hunt.

46. Power to make rules.— (1) Government may make rules for the purposes of carrying into effect the provisions of this Act.

(2) In particular and without prejudice to the generality of the foregoing powers, such rules may provide for—

- (a) the functions and powers of the Board;
- (b) the powers and duties of the officers and other persons specially authorised to perform functions under this Act;
- (c) the form in which and the terms and conditions, on which a licence, special licence, a permit or a special permit may be granted;
- (d) the fees to be charged for any licence or permit or special licence or special permit;
- (e) in the case of any species of wild animals the number and the sex that may be killed under special permit;
- (f) reward to persons who render help in detection of offences under this Act;
- (g) the authorities by whom the conditions on which, and the manner in which licences may be issued;
- (h) the management of wildlife sanctuaries, national parks and game reserves;
- (i) tenure of office, resignation and terms and conditions of members of the Board;
- (j) the recruitment, tenure of office, terms and conditions of service of the Officers and Servants of the Board, and other persons;
- (k) the delegation of administrative and financial powers to members, Secretary, Officers and Servants of the Board, and other persons; and
- (l) any other matter required under any of the provisions of this Act to be prescribed.

47. Dissolution of the Board.— Government may, by notification in the official Gazette, declare that the Board shall be dissolved on such date and with such consequences as may be specified in the notification.

48. Repeal and validation.— (1) The following enactments in their application to the Province of the Punjab shall be deemed to have been repealed from the date the Punjab Ordinances Temporary Enactment Act, 1973, in so far as it enacted the provisions of the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) Ordinance, 1972 expired:—

- (a) The Elephant Preservation Act, 1879 (Act No. VI of 1879);
- (b) The Wild Bird and Animal Protection Act, 1912 (Act VIII of 1912); and
- (c) The West Pakistan Wildlife Protection Ordinance, 1959 (West Pakistan Ordinance LVI of 1959).

(2) Everything done, action taken or order made under the Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) Ordinance, 1972 and its provisions as enacted by the Punjab Ordinances Temporary Enactment Act, 1973 on or after 25th October, 1972 and before the commencement of this Act shall be deemed to have been validly done, taken or made.

49. Repeal of Punjab Ordinance No. XX of 1973.— The Punjab Wildlife (Protection, Preservation, Conservation and Management) Ordinance, 1973 (Punjab Ordinance No. XX of 1973), is hereby repealed.

FIRST SCHEDULE

[See Section 2 (d)]

PART-I

Wild birds and animals which may be hunted on an ordinary shooting licence.

A: BIRDS

Name of species	Bag limit or number allowed per gun.	Time and season when hunting permitted
Category one—		
1. All the ducks within the family anatidae, including the tree ducks, diving ducks, surface feeding ducks except those ducks listed under the Third Schedule as protected or listed hereunder in the First Schedule.	Not more than ten ducks of all species per day	1st October to 31st March on Saturday and Sunday
2. Cotton teal (<i>Nettapus Coromandelianus</i>).	Not more than two per day	Ditto
Category two—		
3. Lesser white fronted goose (<i>Anser albifrons</i>)	Three only per day	1st October to 31st March
Category three—		
Snipes, Plovers, Waders and Allied Waterfowl		
4. Fantail Snipe (<i>Capella gallinage</i>)	Eight only per day	Ditto
5. Jack Snipe (<i>Capella minima</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
6. Purple Moor hen (<i>Porphyrio porphyria</i>)	Two only per day	Ditto
7. Moorhen (<i>Gallinula, chloropus</i>)	Four only per day	Ditto
8. Coot (<i>Fulica atra</i>)	Twelve only per day	Ditto
9. Red Wattled Lapwing (<i>Vanellus indicus</i>)	Two only per day	Ditto
10. White Tailed Lapwing (<i>Vanelus Leucurus</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
11. Grey plover or Black Bellied Plover (<i>pluvialis, Squalarola</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
12. Curlew (<i>numenius arquat</i>)	Ditto.	Ditto

Name of species	Bag limit or number allowed per gun.	Time and season when hunting permitted
13. Black Tailed godwit (<i>Limosa Limosa.</i>)	Six only per day of all species of waders listed below	Ditto
14. Wood Sandpiper (<i>tinga glareola</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
15. Green Shank (<i>Tringa nebularia</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
16. Marsh Sandpiper (<i>Tringa Stagnatilis</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
17. Common Redshank (<i>Tringa stagnatilis</i>)	Six only per day	Ditto
18. Dunlin (<i>Calidris alpina</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
19. Curlew Sandpiper (<i>Calidris ferruginea</i>)	Ditto	Ditto

Category Four–

Pheasianids

20. See See, (<i>Ammoperdix griseogularis</i>)	Not more than five per day	15 th November to 15 th February on Saturday only
21. Black Partridge (<i>Francolinus francolinus</i>)	Not more than six per day	Ditto
22. Grey Partridge (<i>Francolinus Pondicerianus</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
23. Common Quail (<i>Coturnix cotrunix</i>)	Five only per day	15 th August to 15 th April
24. Black Breasted or Rain Quail (<i>Coturnix coromandelica</i>)	Not more than six per day	1 st August to 30 th September

Category Five–

Pigeons and doves

25. Blue Rock Pigeon (<i>Columba livia</i>)	Ten only per day	Ditto
26. Common Ring Dove (<i>Streptopelia decaocto</i>)	Six only per day	Ditto
27. Rufous Turtle Dove (<i>Streptopelia orientalis</i>)	Ten only per day	Ditto
28. Little Brown Dove or Senegal Dove (<i>Streptopelia senega-lensis</i>)	Six only per day	1 st October to 31 st March
29. Long Tail persian Dove	Ditto	Ditto

Name of species	Bag limit or number allowed per gun.	Time and season when hunting permitted
30. Turtle Dove (<i>Turtur auritus</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
Category Six– Sandgrouse, Bustards and Stone curlews		
31. Imperial Sandgrouse, (<i>Pterocles orientalis</i>)	Eight only per day	1 st November to 31 st March
32. Stone Curlew (<i>Burhinus Oedipnemus</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
33. Jornden Courser (<i>Cursorius bitorquatus</i>)	Two only per day	Ditto
33(i). Psittacidae (<i>Parakeets</i>) excluding Rose Ringed Parakeet)	Three birds per day except Alexandrine Parakeet	1 st August to 31 January
33(ii). Cuculidae (<i>Cuckoos</i>)	Three birds per day	Ditto
Category Seven Birds of Prey		
34. Hawks	Three birds per day	1 st November to 31 st March
35. Buzzards	Ditto	Ditto
36. Harriers	Ditto	Ditto
37. Falcons	Ditto	1 st September to 31 st December
38. Luger Falcon	Ditto	15 th June to 15 th December
38(i). Strigidae (Owls)	Ditto	1 st August to 31 st January
Category Eight		
39. House Sparrow (<i>Passor domesticus</i>)	No limit	1 st August to end of February
40. Estrilidae (<i>Munias</i>)(excluded)	Ditto	Ditto
41. Plocidae (<i>Bayas, Weaver bird</i>)(excluded)	Ditto	Ditto
42. Sturnidae (<i>Mynas</i>)	Three birds per day	1 st August to 31 st January
43. Motacillidae (<i>Wagtails</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
44. Timaliidae (<i>Babblers</i>)	Ditto	Ditto

Name of species	Bag limit or number allowed per gun.	Time and season when hunting permitted
45. Sylvidae (<i>Warbler</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
46. Pycnonotidae (<i>Bulbuls</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
47. Phipiduridae (<i>Fly catchers</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
48. Alaudidae (<i>Larks</i>)	Ditto	Ditto
49. Turdidae (<i>Robin, Chats, Starts</i>)	Ditto	Ditto

B: Mammals

Name of species	Bag limit or number allowed per gun.	Time and season when hunting permitted
1. Cape hare (<i>Lepus capensis</i>)	Three hares per day	1 st September to 31 st March
2. Desert hare (<i>Lapus nigricollis dayanus</i>)	Ditto	Ditto

Part-II

Wild Animals for the hunting of which a Special permit is required

(See Clause (iii) of Section 9)

Serial No.	Name of species	Season when hunting is permitted	Localities where hunting is permitted
1.	Possessions / shooting / capturing of all kind of peafowls / pheasants (endemic & exotic)	1 st October – 31 st January Possessions under Rule 3(5)(b) Shooting / capturing under Rule 3 (2) (c)	Specified in Special Permit Certificate of lawful possession

SECOND SCHEDULE

[See Section 12 (2)]

Animals, Trophies or Meat for the possession, transfer or captive management in private sector or export of which certificate of Lawful Possession is required.

- (1) Any live Game Animal.
- (2) Any Trophy or Meat derived from a Game Animal.
- (3) Trophy of any animal in the Third Schedule and of any animal protected in any other Province of Pakistan.
- (4)
 - i. Black buck (*Antelope cervicapra*)
 - ii. Chinkara (*Gazella bennettii*)
 - iii. Hog deer (*Axis porcinus*)
 - iv. Spotted deer (*Axis axis*)
 - v. Nilgai (*Boselaphus tragocamelus*)
 - vi. Punjab Urial (*Ovis vignei*)

THIRD SCHEDULE

[See Section 2 (n) and 9 (ii)]

Wild Birds and Animals protected throughout the year.

A–BIRDS

Category one–

The following ducks:

1. Lesser Whistling teal (*Dendrocygna Javanica*)
2. Greater Whistling teal (*Dendrocygna bicolor*)
3. Ruddy Shelduck, (*Tadorna tadorna*)
4. Common Shelduck, (*Tadorna tadorna*)
5. Marbled Teal (*Marmaronetta angustirostra*)
6. Falcated Teal (*Anas falcate*)
7. Baikal Teal (*Anas formosa*)
8. Spotbilled Duck (*Anas poscilorhyncha*)
9. Golden Eyed Duck (*Bucephala clangula*)
10. Long Tailed Duck (*Clangula hyemalis*)
11. Smew (*Mergue albellus*)
12. Goosander (*Mergus merganser*)
13. Red breasted merganser (*Mergus serrator*)
14. Red crested pochard (*Netta rufina*)
15. White Headed or Stiff tailed Duck (*Oxyura leucocephala*)
16. Nukhta or Comb Duck (*Sarkindiornis melanotos*)

Category two–

Swans

17. All Swans of the genus cygnus including Bewick's swan (*Cygnus columbianus bewickii*), whooper swan (*Cygnus Cygnus*) and Mute swan (*Cygnus olor*).

Category three–

Geese

18. Grey Leg Goose (*Anser anser*) and Bar-headed goose (*Anser indicus*)

Category four–

Crans, bustards, coursers and quails

19. All members of Gruidae family including Demoiselle crane (*Anthropiodes virgo*), Common crane (*Grus grus*) and Siberian crane (*Grus leucogeranus*)
20. Houbara bastard or Mequeen's bustard (*Chlamydotis undulate macqueenii*)
21. Great Indian bustard (*Choriotis nigriceps*)

22. Little bustard (*Otis tetrax*)
23. Little bustard quail (*Turnix sylvatica*)
24. Button quail (*Turnix tanki*)

Category five–

Pelicans

25. All Pelicans of the genus *pelecanus* including Dalmatian pelican (*Pelecanus crispus*), Rosy pelican (*Pelecanus onocrotalus*) and Spot billed pelican (*Pelecanus philippensis*)

Category six–

Egrets and herons

26. All Egrets, Herons, Night Herons and Bitterns of the family of *Ardeidae* including purple heron (*Ardea Purpurea*) Chestnut bittern (*Ixobrychus cinnamomeus*) and Common Bittern (*Botaurus stellaris*), Cattle egret (*Bubulcus ibis*) and Large egret (*Egretta alba*).

Category seven–

Storks

27. All storks of the family Ciconiidae including White stork (*Ciconia ciconia*), White necked stork (*Ciconia episcopus*), Black stork (*Ciconia nigra*) Black necked stork (*Ephippiorhynchus asiaticus*) and Painted stork (*Mycteria leucocephala*).

Category eight–

Ibises and spoonbills

28. All Ibises and Spoonbills including the glossy Ibis (*Plegadis falcinellus*), White ibis (*Threskiornis melanocephalus*) and spoonbill (*Platalea leucorodia*)

Category nine–

Flamingoes

29. Lesser flamingo (*phoeniconaias minor*) and Greater flamingo (*Phoeniconaias roseus*)

Category ten–

Pheasianids

30. All hill pheasants including the Cheer (*Catreus wallichii*) Impeyan or Monal (*Lophophorus impeyanus*). Kaleej (*Lophura leucomelana*), Koklas (*Pucrasia macrolopha*) and western horned tragopan (*Tragopan melanocephalus*)
31. Chukor partridge (*Alectoris chukar*)

Category eleven–

Plovers, Stone curlews, Waders Water birds and Gallinules

32. Water Rail (*Rallus aquatious*)
33. White Breasted water hen (*Amaurornis phoenicurus*)

34. Water cock (*Gallicrex cinerea*)
35. Pheasant tailed Jacana (*Hydrophasianus chirurgus*)
36. Sociable lapwing *Vanellus gregarious*)
37. Yellow-wattled Lapwing, *Vanellus vanellus*
38. Green plover or Peawit (*Vanellus malabaricus*)
39. Solitary Snipe (*Gallinago solitaria*)
40. Painted Snipe (*Rostratula benghalensis*)
41. Wood cock (*Scolopax rusticola*)
42. Avocet (*Recurvirostra avosetta*)
43. Great stone plover (*Esacus recurvirostris*)
44. Indian courser (*Cursorius coromandelicus*)
45. Cream coloured courser (*Cursorius cursor*)

Category twelve–

Sangrouse, pigeon and Doves

46. Large pintail Sandgrouses (*Pterocles alchata*)
47. Coronetted sandgrouse (*Pterocles coronatus*)
48. Indian Sandgrouse (*Pterocles coronatus*)
49. Houbara Bustard or Mcqueens Bustard (*Chalmydotis undulate*) areas of Tehsil Kot Adu of Muzaffargarh District, Tehsil Chaubara, Layyan and Karor Lal Easan of Layyah District, Jhang and Shorkot Tehsils of Jhung District Khushab and Nurpor Tehsils of Khushab District and Mankera, Bhakkar and Kalur Kot Tehsils of Bhakkar District.
50. Close barred or Painted Sandgrouse (*Pterocles indicus*).
51. Spotted sandgrouse (*Pterocles senegallus*)
52. Wood pigeon (*Treron Phoenicoptera*)
54. Spotted Dove (*Streptopelia chinesis*)
55. Red turtle dove (*Streptopelia tranquebarica*)

Category thirteen–

Birds of Prey

56. Eagles, Vultures and Kites

Category fourteen–

57. Rosy starling (*Sturnus roseus*) and Common starling (*Sturnus vulgaris*)

B: MAMMALS

Category one–

Carnivores

58. Black Bear (*Selenarctos thibetanus*)

59. Leopard or Panther (*Panthera pardus*)
60. Snow leopard (*Panthera unica*)
61. Leopard cat (*Felis benghalensis*)
62. Caracal (*Felis caracal*)
63. Desert cat (*Felis libyca*)
64. Jungle Cat (*Felis chaus*)
65. Fishing cat (*Felis viverrina*)
66. Himalayan palm civet (*Paguma larvata*)
67. Small Indian civet (*Viverricula indica*)
68. Yellow throated marten (*Martes flavigula*)
69. Ratel or Honey Badger (*Mellivora capensis*)
70. Smooth coated otter (*Lutra perspicillata*)
71. Striped hyaena (*Hyaena hyaena*)
72. Hill Fox (*Vulpes Vulpes griffithi*)
73. Indian wolf (*Canis lupus pallipes*)
74. Wolf (*Canis lupus*)
75. Small Indian mongoose (*Herpestes aurpunctatus*)
76. Common Indian mongoose (*Herpestes mungo*)
77. Ruddy mongoose (*Herpestes smithi*)

Category two–

Ungulates

78. Barking Deer (*Muntiacu muntjak*)
79. Goral (*Naemorhedus goral*)

Category three–

Other mammals

80. Indian fruit bat (*Pteropus giganteus*)
81. Rhesus monkey (*Macaca mulatta*)
82. Scaly anteater or Indian pangolin (*Manis crassicaudatus*)
83. Flying squirrel (*Petaurista petaurista*)
84. Indus dolphin (*Platanista minor*)

C: Reptiles

85. All monitor lizards of the genus *Varanus* and Spiny tailed lizards of the genus *Uromastix*
86. All snakes of the family *Colubridae* containing non-poisonous and beneficial snakes and the genus.

87. All Crocodiles including Mugger, *Crocodilus palustris* and the fish eating crocodile or gavial *Gavialis gangeticus*.
88. All species of Order *Chelonia*

FOURTH SCHEDULE

SCHEDULE OF WILD BIRDS AND ANIMALS WHICH ARE NOT PROTECTED

[See section 2 (v)]

Serial No.	Scientific Name	English Name	Vernacular Name
1.	<i>Corvus Levillantit</i>	Himalayan jungle crow	Kowa, Kawwa, Kan, Pahari kowa.
2.	<i>Corvus splendens</i>	House Crow	Kan, kowa, desi kan.
3.	<i>Psittacula krameri</i>	Rose ringed parakeet	Parrot
4.	<i>Caprimulgus europasus unwivi</i>	Himalayan night jar	Chippak, Chappa, dab chiri, dabbak, andha chirya
5.	<i>Caprimulgus macrurus</i>	Long tailed night jar	Chapks
6.	<i>Caprimulgus Indicus</i>	Indian jungle night jar	Kapoo
7.	<i>Lynocornis carviniceps</i>	Great eared night jar	Sandhya muzanki
8.	<i>Canis aureus</i>	Jackal	Giddar, Yal, phival
9.	<i>Hystrix indica</i>	Indian porcupine	Suai-sa kundewalli
10.	<i>Mus (whole family)</i>	Rats and Mice	Chuha, Chuhi
11.	<i>Sus scrofa cristatus</i>	Wild boar	Suhar, barla, janwar, khanzeer